ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET A

Chapter 8: **The Gupta Era: An Age of Tireless Creativity** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** 3rd to 6th century CE	capital Pāṭaliputra
2	**(a)** Chandragupta II	dedicated to Viṣhṇu
3	**(a)** dharaṇi-bandha (unifier of the Earth)	expanded the empire
4	**(c)** A Record of Buddhistic Kingdoms	travelogue
5	**(c)** Vākāṭaka dynasty	matrimonial alliance
6	**(c)** land tax	plus fines, trade taxes
7	**(d)** Āryabhaṭīya	mathematics and astronomy
8	**(b)** Bṛihat Saṃhitā	weather, town planning, farming
9	**(d)** Maharashtra	paintings on Jātaka tales
10	**(c)** Śhiva	temple builders

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Art, literature, science flourished (2).	2
12	Over 1,600 years old and rust-free (2).	2
13	Gupta ruler who expanded the empire (1); Prayāga Praśhasti (1).	1+1
14	To announce their achievements to people (2).	2

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	After Kuṣhāṇa decline (1); regional rulers near UP (1); empire under Chandragupta I and II (1).	1+1+1
16	Conquests and tribute (1.5); patron of art and trade (1.5).	1½+1½
17	Reinstated many as tributaries (1.5); avoided direct control (1.5).	1½+1½
	OR: 6 tonnes, dedicated to Viṣhṇu (1.5); no rust due to protective layer (1.5).	1½+1½
18	People prosperous and happy (1.5); charity houses, but harsh treatment of chaṇḍālas (1.5).	1½+1½
	OR: One viewpoint (1.5); need corroboration (1.5).	1½+1½

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) Culture and science (2). (ii) Chandragupta I, Samudragupta, Chandragupta II (1). (iii) Conquest, tribute, alliances (2).	2+1+2
	OR: (i) Chandragupta II (1). (ii) Viṣhṇu (1). (iii) Doesn't rust (1). (iv) Metallurgy skills (2).	1+1+1+2
20	(i) Warrior-patron (2). (ii) By Harisena (2). (iii) Tributaries (1).	2+2+1
	OR: (i) Chinese pilgrim (1). (ii) Charity houses (1). (iii) Social discrimination (1). (iv) Avoid bias (2).	1+1+1+2

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET B

Chapter 8: **The Gupta Era: An Age of Tireless Creativity** | Class 7 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** Pāṭaliputra	present-day Patna
2	**(c)** Vikramāditya	Gupta ruler
3	**(d)** veena	patron of art
4	**(c)** outcastes living outside the city	harsh treatment
5	**(b)** regent	after her husband died
6	**(d)** the Mediterranean, Southeast Asia and China	Indian Ocean network
7	**(a)** spins on its axis	explains day and night
8	**(d)** yakṣha sending a message through a cloud	poem
9	**(a)** Madhya Pradesh	Viṣhṇu carvings
10	**(b)** Assam	Varman dynasty

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Chinese Buddhist pilgrim (1); to visit sites and collect texts (1).	1+1
12	Records of land given to local rulers, priests (2).	2
13	Land tax (1); trade and mine taxes (1).	1+1
14	Daughter of Chandragupta II who ruled the Vākāṭaka kingdom as regent (2).	2

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Provinces and land grants (1.5); copper plates and tax collection (1.5).	1½+1½
16	Mahārājādhirāja, samrāṭ (1); conquest (1); alliances (1).	1+1+1
17	Married Vākāṭaka prince (1); regent after his death (1); built Viṣhṇu temples (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Textiles, spices, ivory exports (1.5); Indian Ocean trade, Socotra (1.5).	1½+1½
18	Āryabhaṭīya (1); Earth's rotation (1); year length, eclipses (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Astronomer and mathematician (1); Bṛihat Saṃhitā (1); weather and town planning (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) Provinces, land grants (2). (ii) Land tax, fines (2). (iii) Army, temples, scholars (1).	2+2+1
	OR: (i) Indian Ocean trade (2). (ii) Textiles, spices, Mediterranean (2). (iii) Strategic stop (1).	2+2+1
20	(i) Vākāṭaka prince (1). (ii) Regent (1). (iii) Viṣhṇu (1). (iv) Strong ties (2).	1+1+1+2
	OR: (i) Āryabhaṭīya, Earth's rotation (2). (ii) Bṛihat Saṃhitā (2). (iii) Science foundation (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.